COMPLAINT COMPASS · WHEN THEY ASK “HOW WILL YOU SCALE THIS?”

Scalability: say it like you’re thinking out loud

About 70 seconds. Don’t read it word for word; the prompts below are enough.

> “Let me start with how big this is. In India, quick-commerce apps get about seven point eight million orders every day. Some of those go wrong, and people complain.
>
> We can see part of it in government data. The national consumer helpline gets about five thousand calls a day. In one year, Swiggy had about ninety-five hundred complaints there, and Zomato about seven thousand. And it’s the same few problems again and again: refunds that never came, late deliveries, damaged items, payments that failed. Those are exactly the problems our system catches early.
>
> And that’s only what reaches the government. Most people just complain to the app directly. We estimate eighty thousand to two lakh complaints a day in quick commerce. That sounds huge, but it’s only one to three complaints a second.
>
> So can we handle it? Yes. Reading a complaint is the slow part, and it doesn’t share anything, so we just add more workers. One worker reads about fifteen complaints a second.
>
> Take Swiggy’s Instamart. It has about a quarter of the market, so roughly two million orders a day. If two in every hundred lead to a complaint, that’s about forty thousand complaints a day, which is less than one a second. Even at busy times, say five times that, one reading worker is enough. So Instamart runs on two servers, and one of those is just a backup. The AI bill is about fifty dollars a month.
>
> Saving the complaint under the right issue is the only tricky part, because two workers could create the same issue twice. So each area, like payments or delivery, gets its own single worker, and all the areas work at the same time. A new company just adds new areas. If one area gets too busy, we split it.
>
> And it stays cheap. Most complaints never need the expensive AI, so at ten million complaints a month we pay about four hundred dollars.
>
> It’s not built at that size yet, so the first thing we’ll do is a load test.”

Or remember six prompts and talk

1. **How big:** 7.8M quick-commerce orders a day.
2. **Government data:** helpline ~5,000 calls a day; Swiggy ~9,500, Zomato ~7,000 a year. Same problems: refunds, late delivery, damaged items, failed payments; exactly what we catch early.
3. **Real volume:** most complain to the app directly; 80,000 to 2 lakh a day = only 1–3 a second.
4. **Reading:** shares nothing, so add workers; ~15 a second each.
5. **Swiggy Instamart:** ~2M orders a day → ~40,000 complaints → under 1 a second → 2 servers (1 backup), ~$50 a month.
6. **Saving:** one worker per area so no duplicates; new company = new areas; busy area = split.
7. **Cost and honesty:** ~$400 a month at 10M complaints; not built at that size yet, load test first.

Only if they ask for detail

Swiggy Instamart, worked out

Step	Calculation	Result
Orders a day	25% market share × 7.8M orders	~1.95M
Complaints a day	2% of orders (our assumption)	~39,000 (0.45 a second)
Busy-hour peak	5× average (our assumption)	~2.3 a second
Reading workers	2.3 ÷ 15 per worker	1 (plus a backup)
Saving workers	7 areas × ~3.5 a second each = ~24	7, well under capacity
Servers	All workers and the database fit on one	2 (one is a backup)
Model cost	~1.17M complaints a month × $4.33 per 100,000	~$51 a month

Market share: GAEE India report, 2025 (Instamart 25%). Order volume: RedSeer via GAEE. Food-delivery orders not included (no verified figure).

Escalated to the government, FY24	Per year	Per day
Flipkart	1,60,857	~440
Amazon	58,875	~160
Swiggy	9,527	~26
Zomato	6,983	~19
Blinkit	1,244	~3
All e-commerce	4,45,960	~1,200
RBI Ombudsman (FY25, banking)	13.34 lakh	~3,650

Volume a month	Workers	Partitions	Model cost
1M (one business)	2	7	$43
10M (~10 businesses)	2–4	~70	$433
100M (~100 businesses)	13–16	~700	$4,330

Throughput projected from latencies measured on the live run; model cost = $4.33 per 100,000 (measured) × volume, hosting excluded.

Sources: Storyboard18 citing the Consumer Affairs Ministry's FY24 data (company figures); Storyboard18, 21 May 2025 (complaint types: deficient service, refunds not processed, cancellation charges); PIB, 14 Mar 2025 (1,55,138 helpline calls in Dec 2024); The Tribune/ANI (RBI); GAEE report citing RedSeer (7.8M orders a day, Jan 2026). "80,000 to 2 lakh a day" is our estimate assuming 1–3% of orders lead to a complaint. Don't quote unverified 2025 company figures (e.g. Zepto 5,774).